

BEN HANKINS

Solutions Engineer | Pre-Sales Technical Strategy, Enterprise Discovery & AI Systems
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Solutions Engineer with 7+ years across the full customer technical lifecycle: discovery, POC, and technical evaluation through production deployment. Spent five years in IBM Client Engineering across 12 named enterprise accounts, supporting \$13M in pipeline anchored by a \$10.1M engagement at CenterPoint Energy, where hands-on Terraform and OpenShift work turned technical evaluations into signed, deployed infrastructure. Works across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud in regulated industries, stays hands-on shipping full-stack AI applications, leads with infrastructure depth rather than sales polish, and builds and deploys what gets demoed.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Pre-Sales & Delivery	Technical Discovery, Solution Design, Stakeholder Alignment, POC Execution, Customer Enablement, SOC 2 Compliance Architecture
Cloud & Platform	AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, Route 53, CloudWatch), IBM Cloud, GCP, Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, OpenShift/ROKS), Terraform, Helm, Argo CD / GitOps, Tekton, Ansible, Docker, CI/CD
IBM AI & Data	Cloud Pak for Data, Cloud Pak for Business Automation, watsonx.ai, watsonx.governance, Watson OpenScale, Watson Assistant, Automated Decision Services (ADS)
Development	TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, REST APIs, SQL, Auth (JWT/RBAC), PostgreSQL, Supabase, n8n
AI / LLM	LLM Application Architecture, RAG Pipelines, Multi-Agent Systems, Prompt Engineering & Evaluation, AI Governance, Agentic Coding (Claude Code, Codex)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Solutions Engineer

Oct 2025 - Present

[Sproutflow Studio](#) - New Orleans, LA

- Run a solo product studio delivering production software for clients end to end, from technical discovery through deployment. Recently built and shipped a custom point-of-sale and operations platform for a multi-location franchise, replacing spreadsheet workflows with a single system their staff runs daily. Live demo available on request.
- Design and ship AI products and automation for clients and the studio: multi-agent document generation, retrieval-augmented systems, and a multi-step outreach workflow that matches prospects to service offerings, builds targeted lists with a visual dashboard, and automates personalized email with reply tracking.
- Build full-stack applications on Next.js, Supabase/Postgres, and multi-provider LLMs (Anthropic, OpenAI, Gemini, Groq), using agentic development workflows (Claude Code, Codex) and n8n automation across client and internal projects.

Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2025 - Sep 2025

[Prove AI](#) - Remote

- Drove SOC 2 Type II from a 34% Vanta baseline to a passed audit in six months under the CISO. Starting from company-wide open access with no policies in place, authored least-privilege IAM across the org, established repository security and branch-protection rules, and owned policy authoring and evidence collection across production infrastructure.
- Kept production stable across 4 Kubernetes clusters with a single incident in nine months, and introduced structured, automated CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Helm) where deployments had been manual and ad hoc, cutting deployment time roughly 80%.
- Built OpenSearch dashboards for error tracing across all services and environments, with severity-based filtering that cut mean time to resolution 67%.

IBM — Client Engineering

2019 - 2024

[Austin, TX](#) - Remote

Named accounts: AT&T, Boeing, Cencora, CenterPoint Energy, Hertz, Honeywell, Juniper Networks, Kroger, NBCUniversal, Norfolk Southern, PepsiCo, Verizon

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

2023 - 2024

- Stood up Cencora's move from ODM to Automated Decision Services on CP4BA/OpenShift: configured ADS, installed the Nexus Repository Operator for artifact management, and authored a reusable deployment runbook supporting a \$200K ADS opportunity.
- Authored the full Terraform / IBM Schematics codebase (VPCs, VSIs, security groups, bastion hosts, storage, load balancers) that cut a multi-hour environment build to roughly 4 minutes; the client cloned 29 environments themselves while I ran several concurrent accounts and led skill transfer.
- Deployed and operated Cloud Pak for Data and supporting AI/data services on Red Hat OpenShift using cpd-cli, OLM, custom resources, storage classes, and pull secrets; built GitOps patterns with Argo CD, Kustomize, and Tekton.

Cloud Engineer, Client-Facing Solutions

2021 - 2023

- Built client-facing MVPs and demos including AT&T's Connected Transportation UI (Next.js + Google Maps, geofencing, EMV markers, Snap-to-Roads routing) and Boeing's HR/job-description prototype (React, Carbon, D3); executed POCs and live demos with a strong evaluation-to-signing conversion rate.
- Proactively trained on Terraform ahead of client demand, then led architecture scoping and the technical evaluation that closed CenterPoint Energy's \$10.1M SAP RISE engagement as the only Terraform specialist in the department. Transitioned embedded post-close to own production infrastructure delivery, scaling from 2 to 49 OpenShift environments with Terraform and Helm.
- Led development of pre-sales environments and reusable Terraform automation for client-facing technical evaluations across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud.
- Worked hands-on with watsonx.governance and Watson OpenScale for AI model governance and evaluation, configuring prompt evaluation and custom quality monitors; mentored junior technical specialists through discovery frameworks, POC shadowing, and an IBM patent filing.

Client Technical Specialist, Solutions Engineering

2019 - 2021

- Led technical discovery and delivered Cloud Pak POCs across Data, Business Automation, and Multi-Cloud; provisioned CP4D/CP4BA environments through TechZone and ROKS. Promoted to Cloud Engineer after 14 months.
- Modernized client Java applications for cloud scalability and built Tekton CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment times 35%.

Front End Developer (Contract)

Jan 2019 - Jun 2019

[Kortivity](#) - Austin, TX

- Designed, built, and maintained a Vue-based web scraper Chrome extension enabling recruiters to scrape candidate profiles and gather contact information for outreach, directly supporting the company's core recruiting workflow.

PROJECTS

[greenlit.cv](#) -- Live AI resume-scoring and coaching SaaS: a deterministic ATS analyzer paired with an industry-aware AI narrative layer, with Stripe checkout. Next.js 15, TypeScript, Vercel Postgres, Gemini. Live at [greenlit.cv](#).

[business-plan-writer](#) -- Investor-ready business-plan generator on a five-agent pipeline (validation, parallel market/financial analysis, drafting, critique) with per-step model routing across Groq, Anthropic, and OpenAI. FastAPI, Next.js, Supabase, Stripe.

[solutions-playbook](#) -- Public field guide for Solutions Engineering and Architecture practice: 70+ frameworks, templates, and diagrams across discovery, POC scoping, implementation, and executive communication.

[ai-engineering-studio](#) -- Public translation layer for AI engineering: LLM apps, RAG, agents, evals, and governance made legible for technical and business audiences, with five hands-on labs.

EDUCATION

B.A. Communication & Media Studies

2017

[Mississippi State University](#)

Software Engineering Bootcamp

2018

[General Assembly](#)

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2026)